

# Noah E. Creany, PhD

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## Research

### Protected Area Conservation & Management

My expertise lies in Protected Area Conservation and Recreation Management, specifically applied, interdisciplinary research that integrates social science and ecology to inform management through a social-ecological systems lens.

- Recreation Ecology
  - Human Dimensions of Wildland Recreation
  - Visitor Use Management & Monitoring
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## Professional Experience

### Postdoctoral Research Fellow

2024-2025

*Oak Ridge Institute for Science and Education (ORISE)/ U.S. Forest Service*

- Optimized the U.S. Forest Service National Visitor Use Monitoring (NVUM) program using statistical modeling to reduce data collection intensity and costs while minimizing impacts on data utility.
- Developed gradient-boosted regression model using novel monitoring data to predict site-level daily forest visitation, and computer-vision object-detection workflow for automated trail-use monitoring.

### Research Assistant

2017-2024

*Utah State University*

- Investigated recreation impacts on wildland ecosystems, employing advanced data analytics and machine learning techniques (Python, R) for regression, classification, and clustering.
  - Managed and analyzed complex multi-modal datasets, including spatial, tabular, survey, and raster/imagery data.
  - Collaborated with federal, state, and county land managers to ensure research deliverables met management priorities and timelines.
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## Education

### Utah State University

2020-2024

*PhD, Ecology*

*Logan, UT, USA*

- Research Assistant, Instructor of Record
- Dissertation: *Shifting Paradigms in Recreation and Parks and Protected Areas: Advancing Social-Ecological Systems Frameworks in Park and Protected Area Management*
- Major Professor: Dr. Christopher A. Monz, Supervising Committee: Dr. Mark Brunson, Dr. Wayne Freimund, Dr. Sarah Klain, Dr. Patrick Singleton.

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|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Utah State University</b>                 | 2019                  |
| <i>M.Sc., Recreation Resource Management</i> | <i>Logan, UT, USA</i> |

- Thesis: *Kudos & KOMs: The Effect of Strava Use on Evaluations of Social and Managerial Conditions, Perceptions of Ecological Impacts, and Mountain Bike Spatial Behavior*
- Research Assistant/Teaching Assistant

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| <b>Pennsylvania State University</b>                  | 2012                            |
| <i>B.Sc., Community, Environment, and Development</i> | <i>University Park, PA, USA</i> |

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## Funded Research

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Rocky Mountain National Park Day Use Visitor Access Monitoring</b> | 2025 |
| <i>Rocky Mountain Conservancy \$15,000</i>                            |      |
| <b>Rocky Mountain National Park Day Use Visitor Access Monitoring</b> | 2024 |
| <i>Rocky Mountain Conservancy \$15,000</i>                            |      |

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## Awards

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Utah State University Quinney College of Natural Resources</b> | 2023 |
| <i>Doctoral Student Researcher of the Year</i>                    |      |
| <b>Rocky Mountain Cooperative Ecosystem Studies Unit (CESU)</b>   | 2023 |
| <i>Student Researcher (Honorable Mention)</i>                     |      |

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## Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Van Deursen, J., **Creany, N.**, Monz, C. A., & Freimund, W. (2025). Classifications of Recreation Specialization: Attitudinal and Behavioral Differences Across Specialization Types in the Nature Reserve of Orange County, CA, USA. *Journal of Park and Recreation Administration*. doi: 10.18666/JPra-2025-12883
- **Creany, N.**, Monz, C. A., & Esser, S. M. (2024). Understanding visitor attitudes towards the timed-entry reservation system in Rocky Mountain National Park: Contemporary managed access as a social-ecological system. *Journal of Outdoor Recreation and Tourism*. doi: 10.1016/j.jort.2024.100736
- Minehart, K., Antonio, A. D., **Creany, N.**, Monz, C., & Gutzwiller, K. (2024). Predicting trail condition using random forest models in urban-proximate nature reserves. *Environmental Challenges*. doi: 10.1016/j.envc.2024.100937
- Van Deursen, J., **Creany, N.**, Smith, B., Freimund, W., Avgar, T., & Monz, C. A. (2024). Recreation specialization: Resource selection functions as a predictive tool for protected area recreation management. *Applied Geography*. doi: 10.1016/j.apgeog.2024.103276
- Tomczyk, A. M., Ewertowski, M. W., **Creany, N.**, Ancin-Murguzur, F. J., & Monz, C. (2023). The application of unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) surveys and GIS to the analysis and monitoring of recreational trail conditions. *International Journal of Applied Earth Observation and Geoinformation*. doi: 10.1016/j.jag.2023.103474
- **Creany, N.**, Monz, C. A., D'Antonio, A., Sisneros-Kidd, A., Wilkins, E. J., Nesbitt, J., & Mitrovich, M. (2021). Estimating trail use and visitor spatial distribution using mobile device

data: An example from the nature reserve of orange county, California USA. *Environmental Challenges*. doi: 10.1016/j.envc.2021.100171

- Monz, C., **Creany, N.**, Nesbitt, J., & Mitrovich, M. (2021). Mobile Device Data Analysis to Determine the Demographics of Park Visitors. *Journal of Park and Recreation Administration*. doi: 10.18666/10.18666/JPRA-2020-10541
- Smith, J. W., Miller, A. B., Lamborn, C. C., Spornbauer, B. S., **Creany, N.**, Richards, J. C., Meyer, C., Nesbitt, J., Rempel, W., Wilkins, E. J., Miller, Z. D., Freimund, W., & Monz, C. (2021). Motivations and spatial behavior of OHV recreationists: A case-study from central Utah (USA). *Journal of Outdoor Recreation and Tourism*. doi: 10.1016/j.jort.2021.100426
- Wesstrom, S., **Creany, N.**, Monz, C. A., Miller, A., & D'Antonio, A. (2021). The Effect of a Vehicle Diversion Traffic Management Strategy on Spatio-Temporal Park Use: A Study in Rocky Mountain National Park, Colorado, Usa. *Journal of Park and Recreation Administration*. doi: 10.18666/jpra-2021-10746

### Manuscripts in Press

- **Creany, N.**, Monz, C., Freimund, W. - Strava Metro Mobility Data Provides Accurate Estimates of Recreation Use in Urban-Proximate Protected Areas. Submitted to *Journal of Outdoor Recreation and Tourism*. Accepted 26 Dec 2025.

### Manuscripts in Preparation

- **Creany, N.**, Monz, C. - Direct Trail Management on High-Use Trails Improves the Quality of Recreation Experiences. Target Journal: *Landscape and Urban Planning*.

### Natural Resource & Technical Reports

- Graham, R., Creany, N., & Monz, C. (2021). *Spatial Behavior of Backcountry Anglers and Hikers in Rocky Mountain National Park* [Natural Resource Technical Report]. National Park Service.
- Sisneros-Kidd, A., D'Antonio, A. L., Creany, N., Monz, C. A., & Shoenleber, C. (2019). *Recreation Use and Human Valuation on the Nature Reserve of Orange County, California*. Orange County, California: Utah State University.

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### Professional Affiliations

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| • Ecological Society of America (ESA) | 2022-Present |
| • Recreation Ecology Research Network | 2019-Present |

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### Professional Service

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| <b>Associate Editor</b><br><i>Journal of Outdoor Recreation and Tourism</i> | 2026 - Present |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|

- Manage and referee the peer review process, ensuring high standards for research quality, robustness, and relevance.

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| <b>Journal Peer Reviewer</b><br><i>Scientific Reports</i> | 2024-Present |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|

- Peer-reviewed manuscripts related to recreation management.

**Journal Peer Reviewer**

2021 - Present

*Journal of Park and Recreation Administration*

- Peer-reviewed manuscripts concerning the application of mobile device data for recreation use estimation.

**Journal Peer Reviewer**

2022 - Present

*Landscape and Urban Planning*

- Peer-reviewed manuscripts related to park and protected area planning and management.

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## Teaching Experience

**Data Analysis and Programming for Natural Resource Management**

Spring 2024

*Instructor of Record: NR6580*

*Utah State University*

**Wildland Recreation Behavior**

Fall 2024

*Instructor of Record: ENVS 4500*

*Utah State University*

**Wildland Recreation Behavior**

Fall 2022

*Instructor of Record: ENVS 4500*

*Utah State University*

**Wildland Recreation Behavior**

Fall 2021

*Instructor of Record: ENVS 4500*

*Utah State University*

**Wildland Recreation Behavior**

Fall 2020

*Instructor of Record: ENVS 4500*

*Utah State University*

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## Technical Skills

**Programming Languages**

*Python, R, ArcPy, SAS*

**Software**

*Google Cloud Compute, Google Earth Engine, ArcGIS, QGIS, Adobe CC, LaTeX, Quarto*